Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠Q

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠10

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 5♦
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣7

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣K

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K ♥ A Q 10 9 6 ♦ A Q J 3 ♣ A K	
♠ 8 5 4 3 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 10 8 6 4 ♣ Q 10 3		♠ Q J 10 6 ♥ 8 2 ♦ 9 5 2 ♣ J 9 8 5
	♠ 9 7 2 ♥ K J 5 3 ♦ K 7 ♣ 7 6 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5NT[3]	Pass	6♥[4]
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces
3. asks for kings
4. 2 kings

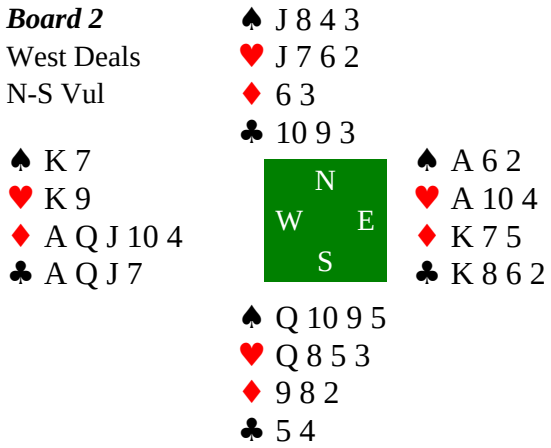
7NT by North
Lead: ♠Q

NORTH has a pretty good hand, and when SOUTH shows ♥ support she naturally thinks about slam.

She has all four Aces but she wants to know about Kings. Unfortunately she can't start at 5NT because that has a different meaning, so she goes through the 4NT sequence even though she already knows the Ace answer.

Finding SOUTH with two Kings was what she wanted.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♠	Pass
5♣	Pass	5♠	Pass
7NT			
All Pass			

7NT by East
Lead: ♠10

WEST is just shy of a 2♣ opening bid, and when EAST shows 13-15 points WEST wants to be in a slam.

WEST cannot use Blackwood because 4NT would be a natural invitation, but with EAST's latest bid being 2NT he can use Gerber.

Two Major Aces and two Minor Kings fill the holes in WEST's hand so he bids 7NT.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A K 5
♥ 7
♦ Q 10 6 5 3
♣ K 10 8 4

♠ J 8 4 3
♥ 10 9 8 5 3 2
♦ 2
♣ 7 5



♠ Q 10 9 7 2
♥ A Q J 6
♦ A 8
♣ 6 3

♠ 6
♥ K 4
♦ K J 9 7 4
♣ A Q J 9 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♦ by South
Lead: ♣7

SOUTH thinks slam may be possible, so she uses Blackwood.

And that's what Blackwood is really good for - keeping you out of slams when you are missing two Aces!

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 9 6 ♥ 7 2 ♦ Q 9 8 4 ♣ K Q 10 2	
♠ K 4 ♥ K Q 10 9 5 ♦ A 7 6 ♣ A 5 4		♠ A Q J 7 3 ♥ A J 8 6 ♦ 5 3 ♣ 8 7
	♠ 8 5 2 ♥ 4 3 ♦ K J 10 2 ♣ J 9 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
2♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by West
Lead: ♣K

WEST knows EAST has at least five ♠s, and they might provide discards for two or three of her minor suit losers.

She tries Blackwood and, sure enough, EAST comes through with two Aces.

Even with all the Aces WEST knows there are not enough points for Grand, so she bids 6♥.